

Mockup guidelines

Niyo — Card Mockup Guidelines

01 Core Philosophy

A Niyo mockup must never look like a vector asset pasted onto a stock image. It is a real object caught in a real slice of time.

Our mockups do not just present the physical card—they continue the narrative of the traveler. The card must look like it has weight, texture, value, and a rightful place in the environment it occupies.

The Niyo Mockup Must Always

- **Feel tactile:** The viewer should instantly understand what the card feels like to touch, grip, or slide out of a wallet.
- **Be light-native:** The card must completely absorb the lighting, color temperature, and color reflections of its surrounding environment.
- **Embrace imperfection:** Perfectly sterile digital renders are disqualified. Subtle micro-scratches, dust particles, and uneven natural highlights make the mockup feel honest.

02 Environment & Placement Rules

The card can be placed across a diverse range of travel environments, but it must adhere to strict integration rules to maintain premium realism.

Contextual Coexistence

- **Natural Integration:** The card should rest on surfaces a traveler would naturally encounter: a rustic wooden cafe table in Florence, a smooth dark stone check-in desk, or tucked gently inside a weathered leather passport holder.
- **Surface Interactions:** Avoid placing the card perfectly flat on a surface, which reads like a corporate pack-shot. Angle the card slightly (15–30 degrees) or lean it against objects to create dynamic shadows and catch natural specular reflections.

Absolute Disqualifiers

- Floating mid-air in a generic digital void without a physical source of light or shadow.
- Placed flat on artificial, high-gloss "luxury" textures (e.g., synthetic gold chrome, fake velvet).

03 Depth, Interaction & Layering (Overlapping)

To avoid a flat, "photoshopped" appearance, our mockups must prioritize depth through intelligent layering and organic overlaps.

[FOREGROUND LAYER] ----> Soft foliage, a traveler's hand, or a glass edge (partial overlap)

[MIDGROUND LAYER] ----> The Niyo Card (sharp, main focus)

[BACKGROUND LAYER] ----> The textured environment (softly blurred, shallow depth of field)

Compositional Layering

- **Three-Layer Depth:** Every mockup should try to organize frames with a clear foreground, midground, and background to mimic real 3D camera optics.
- **Intentional Overlaps:** Allow environmental components to partially overlap the card to anchor it into the scene.

Approved Overlap Use Cases

- **Human Touch:** A traveler's thumb naturally gripping the edge of the card, slightly obscuring part of the artwork or chip.
- **Environmental Textures:** Soft shadows from overhead foliage, a few loose grains of sand from a coastal landscape, or a subtle reflection/refraction from a nearby cocktail glass.
- **Depth Gestures:** The card sticking out of a passport sleeve or wallet slot, where the leather edge physically covers the bottom half of the card.

04 Material Fidelity (Plastic vs. Metal)

The visual rendering behavior must instantly communicate whether the card version is Eco-Plastic or Premium Matte Metal.

1. Premium Matte Metal Variant

The metal card signals sophisticated weight, cosmopolitan confidence, and durability.

- **Edge Treatment:** Metal cards have a precise, distinct bevel. The edges must catch crisp, sharp metallic highlights (rim lighting) that reflect the environment's dominant color tone.
- **Weight Simulation:** When resting on soft surfaces like leather or fabric, the card must show a slight, visible physical depression to convey its genuine structural weight.

2. Eco-Plastic / Composite Variant

The plastic card signals approachable clarity, modern agility, and vibrant life.

- **Light Diffusion:** Unlike metal, plastic allows a minute amount of sub-surface scattering along its edges. Highlights should feel softer, more rounded, and diffused.
- **Specular Behavior:** Reflections on the plastic body should be clean but broad, avoiding the hyper-focused, razor-sharp specular gleam reserved for the metal card edges.

05 Metal Texturing & Finish Architecture

When rendering the premium metal card variant, the texture is what separates a true Niyo asset from flat, processed stock graphics.

Brushed Anodized Titanium Texture

- **Micro-Grain Texture:** The surface must sport a very fine, linear, horizontal directional brush texture. It must look etched, not printed.
- **Sidelighting Imperative:** To reveal this physical micro-texture, always implement directional sidelighting angled between 30–60 degrees across the card face. Frontal lighting that flattens texture is strictly prohibited.
- **Tonal Contrast:** The peaks of the micro-texture grain should catch light highlights, while the troughs drop into deep (but not crushed) shadow, keeping the metal looking rich and dynamic.

06 Structural Detailing: Embossing & Debossing

Dynamic depth map properties must be meticulously applied to all structural elements on the card.

1. Embossed Elements (Raised Graphics/Chips)

- **The EMV Chip:** The metallic contacts of the chip must sit slightly proud of the card surface, catching its own micro-shadows at the base edges.
- **Edge Rolloff:** Raised elements must have a subtle 3D radius. They should catch light on the side facing the environment's primary light source and cast a soft, microscopic shadow on the opposite side.

2. Debossed Elements (Engraved Text/Lines)

- **Depth Realism:** Clean, minimalist geometric lines or text must look structurally stamped *into* the core material.
- **Internal Shadowing:** The inner "walls" of debossed cavities must demonstrate realistic ambient occlusion. The top edge of the engraving cuts off light, creating a dark, sharp internal shadow line that defines its physical depth.
- **Foil Inlays:** If the debossed text features a premium foil inlay (e.g., gold or silver leaf), the bottom of the groove must retain a high-contrast reflective property, catching ambient light even while tucked deep inside the dark engraving.

07 Global Rendering Signature & Unified Color Science

The card mockup must pass the exact same color science filter as our global photography suite to maintain visual harmony across the platform.